investigators, and the producers of the docu- drama had seen the film together and discussed its merits in a film analysis class before going their separate ways to give form and shape to their different agendas. Or, could it be, that the police genre of literature and film-making, which often shapes the trajectories of alleged 'terrorist' incidents, found in 'Dil Se-13 December' a suitable vehicle for the execution of one of their most complex plots till date? We will never know whether or not this is indeed the case, until some of the key actors in this 'film' decide to speak. But it is self-evident that a private news network gaining access to the highest echelons of the home ministry in order to be able to re- enact and shoot on the grounds of Parliament, with the extensive operational cooperation of police and security personnel, points to a close embrace between the security apparatus and a media agency. And just as the justices of the Supreme Court may well have their reasons to continue to point their 'needles of suspicions', we too will have reason to begin looking for, and pointing, our needles of suspicion in the directions that they lead us. We will need to continue to ask questions as to why the events of 13 December and their aftermath needed the extent of 'spin doctoring' that we have seen? We will have to continue to ask why the prosecution's case in the 13 December case had to be argued, not only in the court, but also on air, in living rooms, between commercial breaks. There are no doubts left any more about the fact that the arguments were flimsy and untenable, that they were bad in law, and that they could not be sustained under cross-examination. This is perhaps why they had to be buttressed with so much media hype, in the hope that TRP ratings would work where forensic evidence may fail.

The dense tangle of film and reality in the 13 December case does not begin and end with *Dil Se*; there are two other films that bear looking at as well (and there may well be more to come), one being 26 *December*, and the other *Khakee.* The two films have two distinct approaches, and are noteworthy not because I think they influenced what I think is the 'scripting' of 13 December, but because they are mirrors through which 13 December can be read. *16 December* (titled so because it happens to be the date on which India won the 1971 war against Pakistan, and so is the date when in the film, a Pakistani soldier turned terrorist wants to unleash a nuclear attack on Delhi as an act of vengeance). As can be expected, the film features a dedicated bunch of Indian intelligence operatives (including the model turned actor Milind Soman who portrays a surveillance expert, with a special fondness for mobile phones) who foil the plot and save Delhi, India and the